Quantifiers; cause and effect

Goal: To use quantifiers correctly with countable and uncountable nouns, and to express cause and effect relationships with suitable connectors.

The idea in two lines: Quantifiers tell *how much* or *how many*, and the choice depends on whether the noun is countable. Cause-and-effect connectors explain *why* something happens and *what* it leads to.

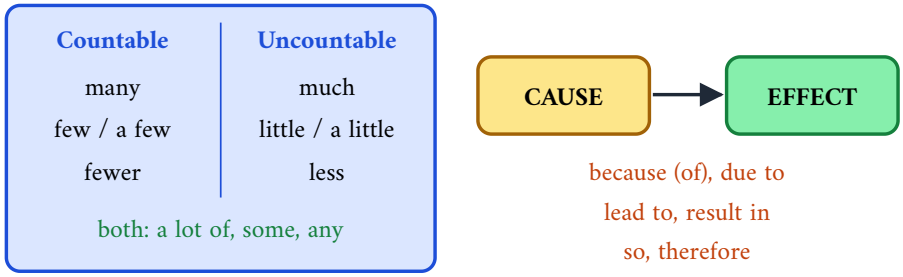


Figure 1: Quantifiers by noun type (left) and the cause → effect chain (right).

🔵 Rules and concepts

1. **Countable nouns** (products, ads): *many, few, a few, fewer, a number of.*
2. **Uncountable nouns** (money, information, advice): *much, little, a little, less, a great deal of.*
3. **A few / a little** = some (positive); **few / little** = almost none (negative).
4. **Cause + clause:** *because, as, since*; **cause + noun:** *because of, due to, owing to.*
5. **Effect verbs:** cause → lead to / result in → effect; reversed: effect → result from / be caused by → cause.
6. **Effect connectors:** *so, therefore, consequently, as a result.*

🟢 Examples

1. Choose: *There is too (many / much) advertising on TV.* **Solution:** much.
   Explanation: *advertising* is uncountable.

2. Rewrite with *because of*: *Consumers buy more because ads are attractive.* **Solution:** Consumers buy more **because of** attractive ads.
3. Rewrite with *result from*: *Fake products lead to health problems.* **Solution:** Health problems **result from** fake products.

🟠 Common BAC mistakes

- Writing *many informations* or *an advice*; these nouns are uncountable.
- Putting a clause after *because of* or *due to*.
- Confusing *result in* (→ effect) with *result from* (← cause).
- Using *less* with plural countable nouns instead of *fewer*.

🟡 Quick review

- Many / few / fewer + plural nouns.
- Much / little / less + uncountable nouns.
- Because + clause; because of / due to + noun.
- Cause leads to / results in effect; effect results from cause.

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